

Guide to Writing a Project Proposal (Essay Format)

This guide explains **how to create a well-structured project proposal document** for academic purposes, especially for Computer Science, IT, or Engineering projects. It follows standard university expectations and aligns with the structure provided in the reference document used for field trip and project reports.

The proposal should be written in **future tense**, clear academic language, and demonstrate feasibility, relevance, and originality.

1. Cover Page

Purpose

The cover page presents essential identification details of the project proposal.

What to Include

- Project title (clear, specific, and descriptive)
- Statement such as: *"A Project Proposal Submitted in Partial Fulfillment of the Requirements for the Award of Bachelor of Science in Computer Science / Software Engineering"*
- Student name(s)
- Student ID(s)
- Programme and Department
- University name
- Supervisor/Lecturer (if applicable)
- Month and Year of submission

Best Practices

- Center all text
- Use a professional font (Times New Roman or Arial)
- Bold the project title
- Keep it to **one page only**

Avoid

- Informal language
 - Unedited placeholders
 - Decorative colors or unnecessary images
-

2. Table of Contents

Purpose

Helps readers navigate the proposal easily.

Guidelines

- List all main sections and sub-sections with page numbers
- Use automatic table generation (recommended)
- Apply consistent numbering (e.g., 1.0, 1.1, 1.2)

Avoid

- Manual page numbering errors
 - Missing sections
-

3. List of Figures

Purpose

Displays all diagrams, charts, or illustrations included or proposed in the document.

Guidelines

- Include figure number, title, and page number
- Example: *Figure 1: Proposed System Architecture*

Note

If no figures are included yet, this section may still be added for **proposed diagrams**.

4. Abstract

Purpose

Provides a concise summary of the entire proposal.

Content (150–300 words)

- Background of the problem
- Aim of the project
- Brief objectives
- Proposed methodology

- Expected outcomes

Best Practices

- Write this section **last**
- Use future tense ("will develop", "will implement")
- Be clear and precise

Avoid

- Detailed explanations
 - Citations
 - Past tense
-

5. Introduction

Purpose

Introduces the project topic and sets the context.

Content

- General overview of the project area
- Importance of the problem domain
- Motivation for the project
- Structure of the proposal

Length

Approximately 1 page

6. Background of Study

Purpose

Provides deeper context and existing practices related to the project domain.

Content

- Industry or domain overview
- Existing systems or approaches
- Challenges in current practices

Best Practices

- Use subheadings where necessary
- Support claims with references

Avoid

- Claiming personal field experience if none was conducted
-

7. Problem Statement

Purpose

Clearly defines the problem(s) the project intends to solve.

Characteristics of a Good Problem Statement

- Specific and focused
- Researchable
- Relevant to Computer Science / IT

Tip

Problems may be listed in short paragraphs or bullet points.

8. Aim of the Study

Purpose

States the overall goal of the project.

Guidelines

- One broad statement
- Action-oriented

Example

"The aim of this project is to design and develop a web-based attendance management system to improve accuracy and efficiency."

9. Objectives of the Study

Purpose

Breaks the aim into achievable steps.

Guidelines

- 4–6 objectives
- Written as bullet points
- Use action verbs (analyze, design, develop, test)

Example

- To analyze existing attendance systems
 - To design the proposed system architecture
 - To implement the system using appropriate technologies
-

10. Significance of the Study

Purpose

Explains the importance and benefits of the project.

Content

- Benefits to users or organizations
 - Contribution to the academic field
 - Potential real-world impact
-

11. Justification of the Study

Purpose

Explains **why** the project is necessary and worth undertaking.

Focus On

- Gaps in existing solutions
- Relevance to current trends
- Alignment with academic requirements

Avoid

- Repeating the significance section word-for-word
-

12. Scope of the Study

Purpose

Defines the boundaries of the project.

Subsections

Delimitation - What the project will cover - Features and platforms included

Limitation - Constraints such as time, resources, data availability

13. Preliminary Literature Review

Purpose

Shows awareness of existing research and systems related to the project.

Guidelines

- Review 5–10 relevant sources
- Summarize key findings
- Identify gaps your project will address

Avoid

- Excessive detail
 - Poor or missing citations
-

14. Methodology

Purpose

Explains how the project will be carried out.

Content

- Research approach (e.g., literature review, interviews)
- System development model (Agile, Waterfall)

- Tools and technologies to be used
- Testing and evaluation methods

Tip

Use subheadings and diagrams where appropriate.

15. Conclusion

Purpose

Summarizes the proposal and restates its value.

Content

- Restate the aim and objectives
 - Expected outcomes
 - Final justification of feasibility
-

16. References

Purpose

Lists all sources cited in the proposal.

Guidelines

- Use a consistent referencing style (APA recommended)
 - Arrange alphabetically
 - Include only cited works
-

General Proposal Writing Tips

- Use future tense throughout
 - Maintain formal academic tone
 - Ensure consistency in headings and formatting
 - Proofread thoroughly
 - Typical length: **15–30 pages**
 - **Any statement that makes a strong claim, presents facts, statistics, trends, or research-based assertions must be referenced** using in-text citation format, for example (*Sunda Ghana Operational Overview*, 2023), and must also appear fully detailed in the **References** section at the end of the paper.
-

This guide can be used as a template for writing final-year project proposals, research proposals, or academic project essays.